

Mostly Priceless

You may or may not have heard of these games, but we really think you should play them. There's nothing to lose, after all – they're all free!

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Cave Story

Cave Story is a 2004 2D platform-adventurer for the PC which features a silent protagonist who tries to foil the designs of an evil overlord – The Doctor – and his army-building designs to take over the world. He does this despite waking up in a cave (where else?) with no recollection of his past.



Gameplay is primarily puzzle platform-based, and the player also has weapons he can shoot enemies with. Switching between multiple weapons is possible, as is the leveling up of said weapons via power ups and capacity upgraders. In the same vein though, taking damage can downgrade your weapons. **Link:** <http://bit.ly/2PuKWY>

Corporate Climber

Most of things we do in our lives have made their way into video games, so why should climbing the corporate ladder be any different? In the browser game *Corporate Climber*, the player aims to... er... climb, crawl and trample his way right from the bottom rung (a lowly peon who for some reason is naked) to the very top of his organisation.

This is done by platforming through levels where you're given specific tasks to complete, which range from avoiding some naughty toilets to sending as



many spam mail as you can. The game is pretty fun, with plenty of subtle and not-so-subtle jabs at the corporate culture and materialistic lifestyles most of us lead. **Link:** <http://bit.ly/aNfRuM>

International Cricket Captain 2005

Think you're better than the Mahendra Singh Dhoni of the world? This is the game for you then. You can choose to captain an English county side and work your way up to, or start directly off with, an international side of your choosing. The *ICC series* are Sports sims devoid of any actual gameplay – your role is more of a non-playing captain or coach as you supervise training schedules and team selection, set fields and decide batting and bowling strategies. You can then sit back and watch the action unfold on the game's highlight engine. **Link:** <http://bit.ly/oG9y1q>

One Chance

Another browser game, this one features a rather interesting premise. All of Earth's



living cells are going to be destroyed in the next six days, and you have the choice to live your last days any way you want to. The game has multiple endings that are triggered by your actions throughout the game, but as the title says – you only get One Chance – and only one ending. There are ways to work around that, of course. We really liked the concept and the ADV-like execution. **Link:** <http://bit.ly/e188oP>

Trilby's Notes

This game is part of the *Chzo Mythos series* created by Yahtzee, of Zero Pronunciation fame, and is the third game of the series. Chronologically though, it slots in at second. The series borrows horror themes from other forms of fiction, with *Trilby's Notes* featuring a rather undesirable alternate dimension a la Silent Hill.



While the earlier two games in the series featured point-and-click gameplay, *Trilby's Notes* relies on keyboard navigation and a text parser for inputting commands. The game is widely considered to have solid writing and challenging puzzle gameplay, and we don't particularly disagree. Give it a go regardless of whether you enjoy your chills and thrills or not. **Link:** <http://bit.ly/22bF50>

Super Mario Bros. Crossover

SMB Crossover is a browser game that is – like its name says – a crossover. The levels are still from *Super Mario Bros.*, but the player now has the option to call in quite a few characters from other games in the NES era. These include Bill from *Contra*, Link from *Zelda*, Samus from *Metroid* and *MegaMan*, to name a few. Each character brings in its own set of moves and attacks to the table, but in a way that fits with the Mario universe and gameplay mechanics.

A lot of thought has been put into adapting the characters for Mario, and it shows. The player

